



The Garamut "The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'!

For PRAYER, PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL PROGRESS

Bethel Global Missions

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DON'T BE DISCOURAGED

OUR MESSAGE: FOR US NOT TO BE DISCOURAGED WITH THOSE CIRCUMSTANCES AND EVENTS THAT WE ARE PERSONALLY FACING TODAY.

OUR FOCUS:

- * For us to be aware of the different areas of our serving that we can be tempted to be discouraged and how we might effectively deal with it.
- * **Discouragement** is the loss of confidence, enthusiasm and hope, it drains our energy / motivation and leads us to give up on goals and genuine desires we have for God and for ourselves.
- * **Discouragement** increases anxiety and sense of heaviness / sadness and withdrawal socially and spiritually.
- * In our journey of serving Christ, we will encounter many distractors and negative thinkers who **actively oppose God's servants** who are seeking to implement God's will here in this world.

OUR PURPOSE:

That in each of the following presentations where we will see God's advice and sometimes prophetic instruction given to his leaders and people and this should be applied to our challenging situations that we are currently facing **The emphasis being on** - "the now" - "today" - not tomorrow or in the future – but what you are currently going through now.

Note: But be assured God's Word to us is "... Do not be afraid! Don't be discouraged by this mighty army, for the battle is not yours, **but God's** - 2 Chronicles 20:15. NLT

OUR WATCHWORD:

"DO NOT BE DISCOURAGED"!

1. IN OUR SEEKING JUSTICE FOR ALL PEOPLES.

- * **DO NOT BE DISCOURAGED** IN YOUR DESIRE AND PURSUIT TO SECURE JUSTICE FOR ALL NEEDY PEOPLES that you interact with.
 - * **BE PERSISTENT UNTIL** you have accomplished establishing fairness and equity for the lives of those in need.
- Jesus set us an example.**
*Isaiah 42:4 He will not fail **nor be discouraged**, Till He has established justice in the earth; And the coastlands shall wait for His law." NKJV*
- * JESUS WAS NOT DISCOURAGED WITH THE CHALLENGING TASK OF BRINGING JUSTICE AND EQUITY / FAIRNESS TO ALL PEOPLES IN ALL NATIONS.
 - * He would not fail (give up for this or that reason) but persistently pursued until he had accomplished what he set out to do of providing justice for all mankind through his redeeming act on Calvary's cross.

APPLICATION:

- * We also should not be discouraged in doing all we can to see that the people are treated the same, with respect, fairness and without favoritism and prejudice.
- * We should not give up or be turned aside from this goal until we have done all that we can possibly do.

2. IN GOD CHOOSING OUR PATHWAY.

- * **DO NOT BE DISCOURAGED** at the pathway that God has chosen for you.
- * **Israel was discouraged with pathway that God has chosen for them** to leave Egypt and enter the promised land.

- * **They were very displeased for the way / direction that he had arranged for them to travel** because it was filled with many trials and difficulties. Numbers 21:4 And they journeyed from Mount Hor by the way to the Red Sea, to go around the land of Edom, and the people **became impatient (depressed, much discouraged)**, because [of the trials] of the way. AMP.
- * IT IS TRUE that there are always going to be challenges and testing along the way where we might feel unsure if this is really the way, God's choice, because our progress seems to be further away from our original promised objective of a land (place) or blessing and plenty.
- * Israel was forced to travel South from Mount Hor away from their goal in Canaan, through the long, difficult and discouraging journey of a harsh desert environment around the border because the king of Edom refused them passage through his territory.
- * Why couldn't the all-powerful God force or change the king's mind so that Israel could pass through Edom making it a shorter route and less challenging route?

APPLICATION:

REMEMBER GOD'S COMFORTING WORD – "TO DO US GOOD AT OUR LATTER END" – "SO THINGS WOULD GO WELL FOR US IN THE END".

Deuteronomy 8:16 and manna to eat in the desert. Manna was something your ancestors had never seen. He did this to take away your pride and to test you, **so things would go well for you in the end.** NCV

- * When God chooses the path that we are to walk, He always has in mind what the end result of our lives will be. That it will be good - mature grown-up persons filled with goodness, grace, faith and faithfulness.

THEREFORE, WE SHOULD NOT BE DISCOURAGED BECAUSE OF THE TRIALS AND TESTINGS IN THE JOURNEY.

3. THE SIZE & STRENGTH OF OUR ENEMY.

- * **DO NOT BE DISCOURAGED** because of the **size and strength** of the enemy's army arrayed against us, regardless of those who oppose your work for God, **BECAUSE** the BATTLE IS GOD'S - **NOT OURS**. 2 Chronicles 20:15 "... Do not be afraid! Don't be discouraged by this mighty army, for the battle is not yours, but God's. NLT
- * **THE BATTLE IS NOT OURS BUT GOD'S.**
- * **GOD WILL DO THE FIGHTING FOR US - on our behalf.**
2 Chronicles 32:7-8 - 7 "Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid or discouraged because of the king of Assyria and the vast army with him, for there is a greater power with us than with him. - 8 With him is only the arm of flesh, **but with us is the Lord our God to help us and to fight our battles.**" **And the people gained confidence from what Hezekiah the king of Judah said.** NIV
- * **WE ALSO SHOULD GAIN CONFIDENCE FROM KNOWING THAT GOD SAID HE WOULD FIGHT FOR US.**
- * **SO, DON'T ALLOW OUR COURAGE TO BE DRAINED AWAY BY THE NEGATIVE OPINIONS OF OTHERS. -**
Deuteronomy 1:28 What is going to happen to us? **Our brothers have drained away our courage** by describing people who are more numerous and taller than we are, and great cities whose defenses appear to be as high as heaven itself! Moreover, they said they saw Anakites there." NET
WE NEED TO BE A PEOPLE WHO CONTINUALLY SPEAKS OF GOD'S MIGHTY POWER AND AWESOME WORKS / DEEDS, HIS MAJESTIC ABILITY AND WILLINGNESS TO FIGHT FOR US.
Psalms 145:3-6 - 3 Great is the Lord and most worthy of praise; his greatness no one can fathom. 4 One generation will commend your works to another; they will tell of your mighty acts. 5 They will speak of the glorious splendor of your majesty, and I will meditate on your wonderful works. 6 They will tell of the power of your awesome works, and I will proclaim your great deeds. NIV

4. DO NOT BE DISCOURAGED – BE AN ENCOURAGER - BY USING WORDS.

Isaiah 41:6-7

6 They help every one his neighbor and **SAY to his brother** [in his tiresome idol making], **Be of good courage!**

7 So the carpenter encourages the goldsmith, and he who smooths [the metal] with the hammer [**encourages**] him who smites the anvil, **SAYING of the soldering, That is good!** And he fastens it with nails so that it cannot be moved. AMP

- * **BE THE KIND OF PERSON WHO ENCOURAGES OTHERS, WHO SPEAKS WORDS THAT LIFT UP AND COMMEND** the efforts of others, USING THOSE TWO POWERFUL WORDS OF – **'THANK YOU'**
- * **SAYING "THANK YOU" TO SOMEONE IS MORE THAN JUST BEING POLITE, IT TRIGGERS IN BOTH THE GIVER AND RECEIVER AN INNER SENSE OF SYMPHONY, HARMONY AND COMMON BOND OF MUTUAL FEELING OF BEING LIFTED UP – BEING NOTICED, AND GENUINELY APPRECIATED.**
- * **ENCOURAGING OTHERS HEALS OUR DISCOURAGEMENT.**

Amen Ps Barry